

User Test Feedback Report

XAI Counterfactual Game Dashboard · May 9, 2026

Participant: Max · Conducted by: Rick de Rijk · Duration: 24 min

1. Session Overview

This document summarises the usability feedback collected during Max's walk-through of the XAI Counterfactual (CF) Game Dashboard. The session followed a think-aloud protocol in which Max navigated the dashboard step-by-step while verbalising observations. A five-question post-interview was conducted at the end. All findings below are derived directly from Max's spoken input and answers.

2. Positive Observations

Max's first impression

"This is a nice layout." — Max, upon first seeing the dashboard [02:49]

The following aspects were received positively or caused no friction during the session:

- Overall layout was well-received immediately upon first view.
- Step-by-step structure was understood and found logical; Max confirmed the order of steps was fine [23:16].
- The colour coding (green = above average, red = below average) for metric scores was understood after a brief explanation [09:02–09:27].
- Max successfully completed all steps and reached the final summary without critical errors.
- The concept of counterfactuals was grasped quickly and correctly articulated [00:19].

3. Key Findings & Redesign Recommendations

The table below maps each finding to a redesign recommendation and assigns a priority level based on how directly it affected Max's experience.

Category	Finding & Recommendation	Priority
Scrolling & Context Loss	Max had to scroll up frequently to re-read metric explanations, and by the time he scrolled back down he had forgotten the information [14:28]. Recommendation: Add inline tooltip/hover explanations directly next to each metric label so context is always accessible without scrolling.	High

Category	Finding & Recommendation	Priority
Metric Relevance	Max stated metrics were entirely uninformative to him: "I just see a number" [15:27]. He judged methods purely visually and assigned no value to metric scores when the image was not visually interpretable [20:28]. Recommendation: Pair each metric with a plain-language one-sentence interpretation (e.g. "Higher = more realistic-looking change"). Consider whether metrics should be shown prominently or moved to a collapsible detail view.	High
Text Volume	Max found there was too much text on screen [22:23] and noted that reading everything slows navigation, leading users to skip important instructions. Recommendation: Reduce instructional text to one or two key sentences per step. Move detailed explanations into expandable sections or tooltips.	High
Step 4 Clarity (Action Matrix)	Max was confused at Step 4 of the Action Matrix [23:31]. He attributed this partly to not reading everything, but the step was still flagged as unclear. Recommendation: Redesign Step 4 with a concrete visual example or a short animated/static walkthrough of what action is expected.	Medium
Summary Section Density	The summary block was perceived as long and text-heavy [14:06]. Max suggested showing metrics with inline explanations rather than a separate block [14:09]. Recommendation: Restructure the summary as a compact card layout with metrics displayed side-by-side with brief labels.	Medium
Human vs. Model Gap	Max understood the gap between his visual judgment and the model metrics only after explicit discussion [21:33–21:49], not from the dashboard itself. Recommendation: Add a brief visual callout at the comparison step explicitly labelling "Your choice" vs "Model's best" to make the contrast immediately apparent.	Medium
Navigation / Scroll Reduction	Max's top change request was simply to reduce the need to scroll [22:06]. Recommendation: Explore a sticky sidebar or fixed info panel for metric definitions, or break the flow into discrete pages/steps so each view is self-contained.	Low

4. Post-Interview Responses (Verbatim Summary)

Q1 — Why did you choose Alibi Proto CF as the best method?

Max's answer

"You could very clearly see a digit in that method, and not in the others." [20:00] — Visual clarity of a recognisable digit was the sole decision criterion.

Q2 — Did the metrics meet your expectations?

Max's answer

"A model can produce those metrics, but if I still see nothing in the image, I do not assign any value to those metrics." [20:28] — Metrics were dismissed when visual interpretation yielded no recognisable output.

Q3 — When did you understand the human vs. metric difference?

Max's answer

"Those metrics are based on what the model sees. If the model is wrong at the front end but too confident, then those metrics still have value for the model." [21:33] — Understanding emerged through reflection, not from dashboard cues.

Q4 — One change to the dashboard?

Max's answer

Three specific suggestions: (1) Reduce scrolling. (2) Add hover tooltips for metric explanations. (3) Less text overall. [22:06–22:23]

Q5 — Was the step order logical?

Max's answer

"Yes, I think the order is fine." [23:16] — No issues with the overall flow sequence.

5. Prioritised Redesign Actions

Based on the findings above, the following actions are recommended in order of priority:

1	Add hover tooltips with one-sentence metric explanations on every metric label.	High
2	Cut instructional text per step to 1–2 sentences; move details behind expandable elements.	High
3	Add a sticky or always-visible info panel for metric definitions to eliminate scroll-and-forget.	High
4	Redesign Step 4 (Action Matrix) with a visual example or guided micro-walkthrough.	Medium
5	Explicitly label the comparison view "Your choice" vs "Model's best" to surface the human–model gap without extra explanation.	Medium

6. Notable Quotes for Design Reference

[14:28] On metric context loss

"If I want to know something now, I have to scroll up. And then by the time I scroll back down I have already forgotten it."

[15:11] On visual-first reasoning

"Yes, purely visual. The metrics do not really interest me."

[21:49] On metric utility

"No." (in response to: "So essentially the metrics did not help you at all?")

[22:14] On improvement

"That you can hover over a metric and then get a short explanation."

[23:16] On step order

"Yes, I think the order is fine."